What Is Supabase?

An entry-level tour, with real screenshots

Where does your data live?

Backend

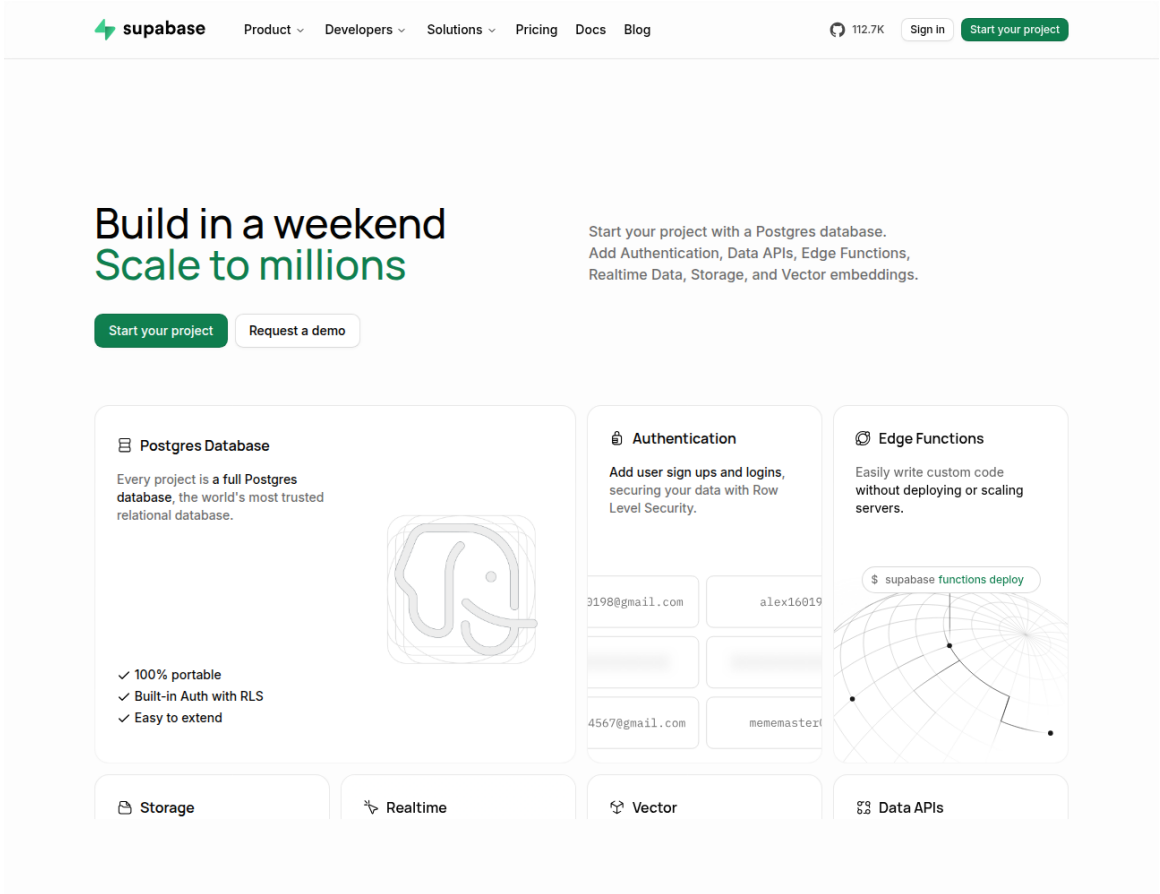
The part of an app you never see

How Supabase Describes Itself

It starts as a database

Then adds what apps need

All in one project



Source

The Four Main Pieces

Database

Tables of your data

Auth

Who is signed in

Storage

Files people upload

API

How your page asks

Database

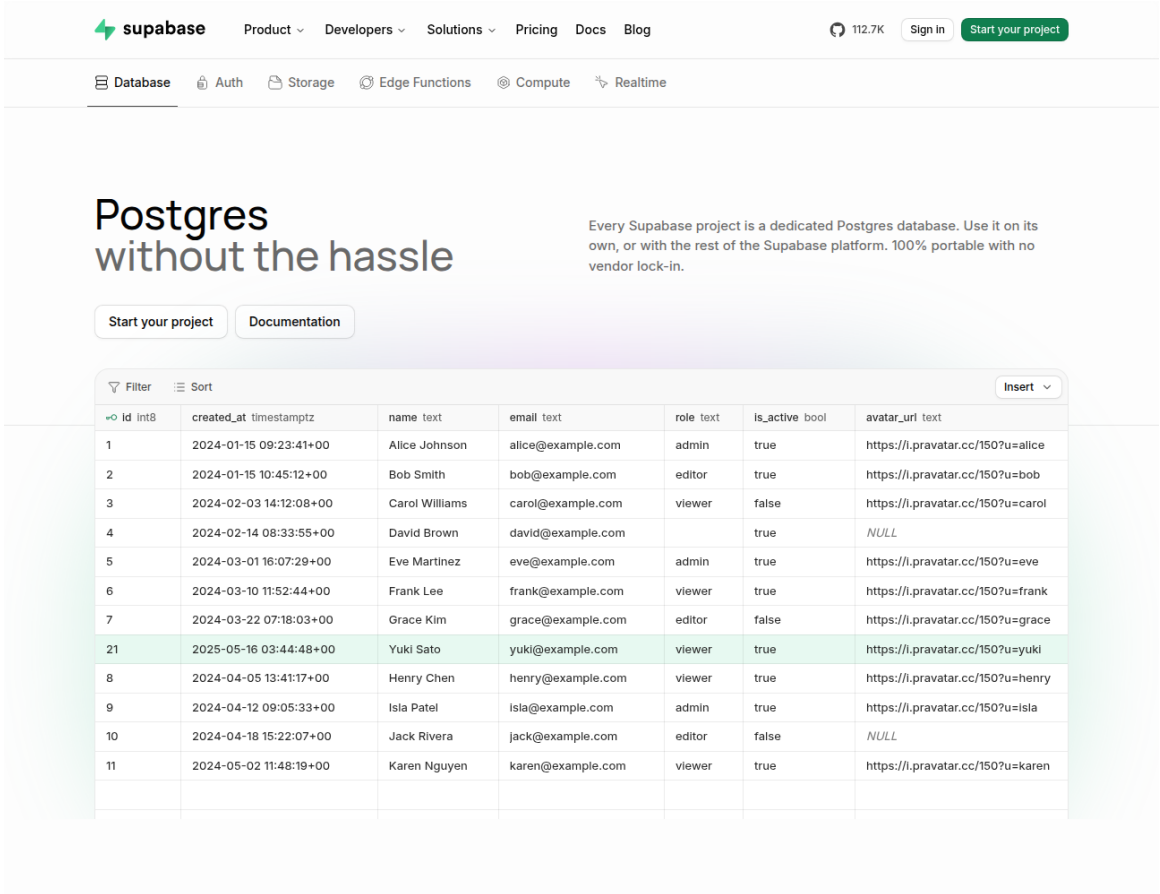
Organised tables your app can read and write

A Table, Concretely

Each row is one record

Each column is a field

A spreadsheet with rules



id int8	created_at timestamptz	name text	email text	role text	is_active bool	avatar_url text
1	2024-01-15 09:23:41+00	Alice Johnson	alice@example.com	admin	true	https://i.pravatar.cc/150?u=alice
2	2024-01-15 10:45:12+00	Bob Smith	bob@example.com	editor	true	https://i.pravatar.cc/150?u=bob
3	2024-02-03 14:12:08+00	Carol Williams	carol@example.com	viewer	false	https://i.pravatar.cc/150?u=carol
4	2024-02-14 08:33:55+00	David Brown	david@example.com		true	*NULL*
5	2024-03-01 16:07:29+00	Eve Martinez	eve@example.com	admin	true	https://i.pravatar.cc/150?u=eve
6	2024-03-10 11:52:44+00	Frank Lee	frank@example.com	viewer	true	https://i.pravatar.cc/150?u=frank
7	2024-03-22 07:18:03+00	Grace Kim	grace@example.com	editor	false	https://i.pravatar.cc/150?u=grace
21	2025-05-16 03:44:48+00	Yuki Sato	yuki@example.com	viewer	true	https://i.pravatar.cc/150?u=yuki
8	2024-04-05 13:41:17+00	Henry Chen	henry@example.com	viewer	true	https://i.pravatar.cc/150?u=henry
9	2024-04-12 09:05:33+00	Isla Patel	isla@example.com	admin	true	https://i.pravatar.cc/150?u=isla
10	2024-04-18 15:22:07+00	Jack Rivera	jack@example.com	editor	false	*NULL*
11	2024-05-02 11:48:19+00	Karen Nguyen	karen@example.com	viewer	true	https://i.pravatar.cc/150?u=karen

Source

Four Things You Do to a Table

Add a row

Find the rows you want

Change a row

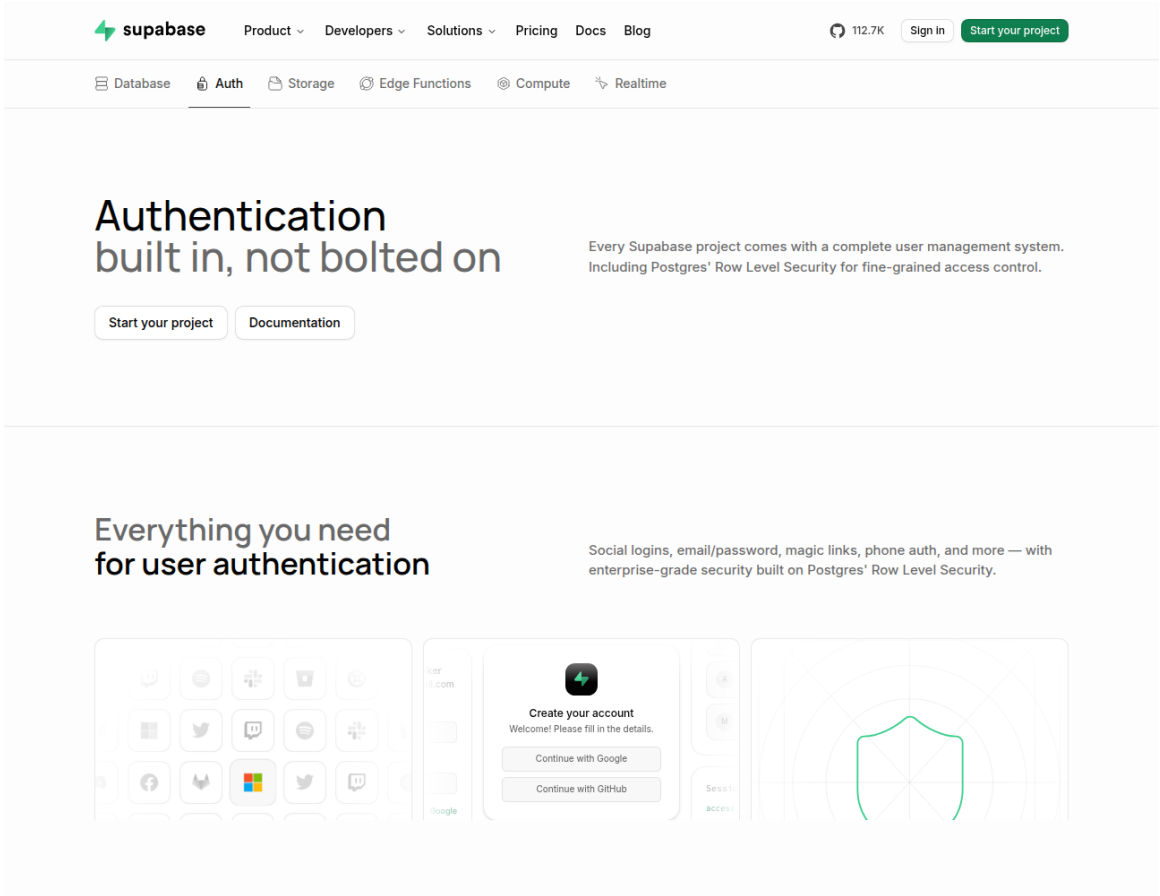
Delete a row

Sign-In, Built In

Email and password

Google, GitHub, others

No login code to write



Source

Storage Is for Files

Profile photos

Uploaded PDFs

Anything too big for a table

Same access rules as the data

API

How your page talks to the database

Why People Use It

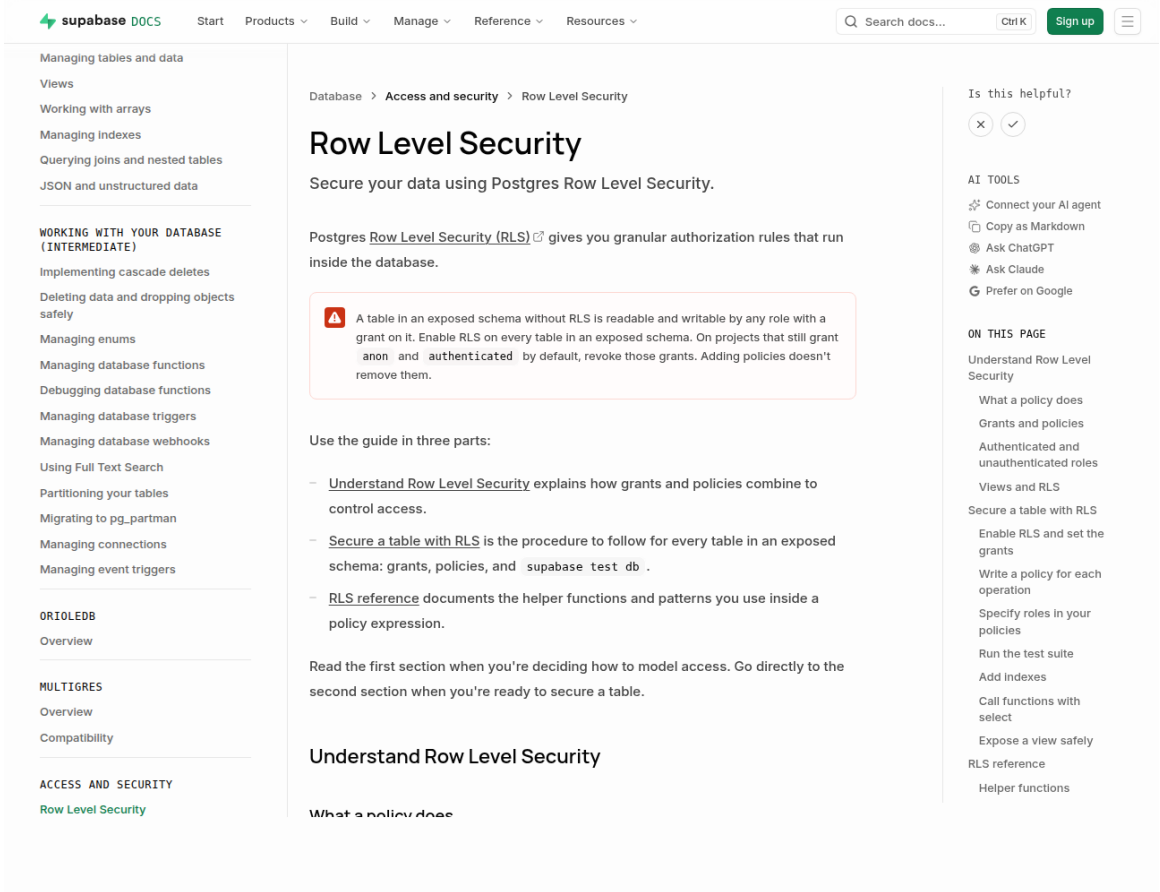
Server	vs	Supabase
You build and run it		You set up a project

The Rule That Protects It

Turn on row level security

Without it, data is open

Supabase warns you itself



Source

Row Level Security, by Example

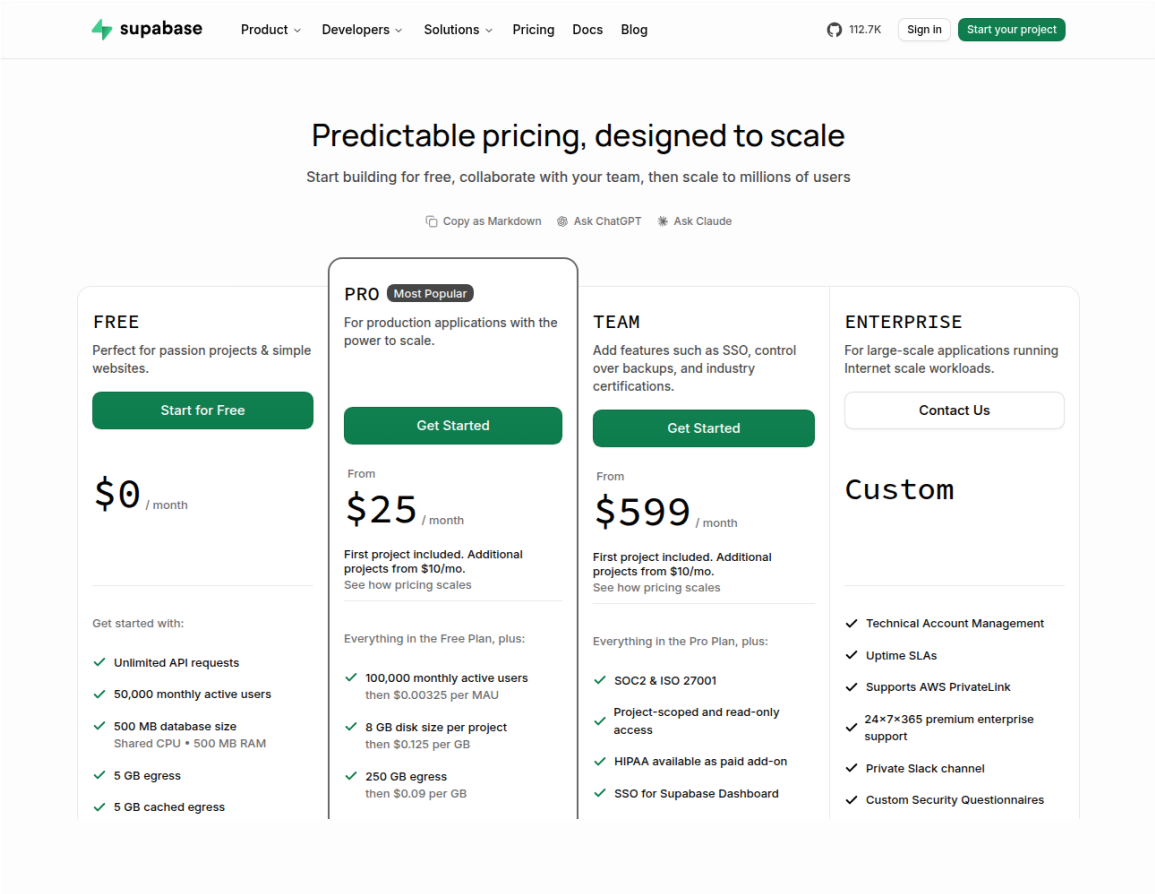
Setting	What a visitor gets
Security off	Every row, read and write
On, with no policy	Nothing at all
On, owner policy	Only their own rows

What It Costs to Start

Free to begin

500 MB of database

50,000 users a month



Source

A Real Project That Uses It

What it stores	Example
Court opinions	Thousands, fetched daily
Is it about asylum?	A yes or a no each
Case details	Country, outcome, more

Your First Ten Minutes

01 Make an account

The free plan is enough

02 Create a project

You get a database right away

03 Make one table

Then add a row by hand

Screenshots, Captured 21 Oct 2026

Screenshot	Captured from
Homepage	supabase.com
Table editor	supabase.com/database
Sign-in	supabase.com/auth
Security warning	supabase.com/docs
Pricing	supabase.com/pricing

What should it remember?